



# Barbados



Barbados is the most easterly of the Caribbean islands. Once solely inhabited by the native Arawak, Barbados was first colonized by British settlers in the 1620s.



## GEOGRAPHY

Encircled by coral reefs. Fertile and predominantly flat, with a few gentle hills to the north.



## CLIMATE

Moderate tropical climate. Sunnier and drier than its more mountainous neighbors.



## PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Some latent tension between white community, which controls politics and much of the economy, and majority black population, but violence is rare. Increasing social mobility has enabled black Barbadians to enter the professions. Despite political stability, and good welfare and education services, pockets of abject poverty remain.



**INSIGHT:** Barbados retains a strong British influence and is referred to by its neighbors as "Little England"



## THE ECONOMY

Well-developed tourism sector based on climate and accessibility. Financial services, offshore banking, and information processing are key industries. Sugar production has dwindled. High cost of living.



## FACTFILE

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Barbados

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 1966

**CAPITAL:** Bridgetown

**POPULATION:** 255,900

**TOTAL AREA:** 166 sq. miles  
(430 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 1542 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** Bajan (Barbadian English), English\*

**RELIGIONS:** Anglican 40%, other 24%, nonreligious 17%, Pentecostal 8%, Methodist 7%, Roman Catholic 4%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Black African 92%, other 8%

**GOVERNMENT:** Parliamentary system

**CURRENCY:** Barbados dollar = 100 cents